



CITY OF CAMBRIDGE

CITY COUNCIL FINAL ACTIONS • APRIL 27, 2026

Regular Meeting

Sullivan Chamber

5:30 PM

Cambridge City Hall, 795 Massachusetts Ave, Cambridge, MA 02139

Published April 29, 2026 2:31 PM

ROLL CALL

Present: Councillor Ayah A. Al-Zubi
Vice Mayor Burhan Azeem
Councillor Timothy R. Flaherty – 5:32PM
Councillor Marc McGovern – 5:35PM
Councillor Patricia Nolan
Councillor E. Denise Simmons – 5:42PM
Councillor Jivan Sobrinho-Wheeler
Councillor Catherine Zusy
Mayor Sumbul Siddiqui

Absent: None

I. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

II. SUBMISSION OF THE RECORD

III. PUBLIC COMMENTS

IV. CITY MANAGER'S AGENDA

1. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to submission of the FY2027 budget and appropriation orders for the General Fund, Water Fund, and Public Investment Fund.

CMA 2026-93

RESULT: Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

2. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$10,000,000.00 to provide funds for the design and construction of improvements along Massachusetts Avenue and vicinity between Bigelow Street and Sindey Street

CMA 2026-95

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

3. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$13,000,000 to provide funds for the reconstruction of various City streets and sidewalks.

CMA 2026-96

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

4. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$12,000,000 to provide funds to replace and modernize the City's Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system.

CMA 2026-98

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

5. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$14,000,000 to provide funds for remediation and improvements at Gold Star Mothers Park.

CMA 2026-99

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

6. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$28,500,000 to provide funds for the Municipal Facilities Improvement Plan.

CMA 2026-100

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

7. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$12,795,000 to provide funds for financing school building upgrades.

CMA 2026-101

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

8. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$8,375,000 to provide funds for the design and construction of surface enhancements and sewer and drainage infrastructure improvements in the Baldwin neighborhood.

CMA 2026-102

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

9. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$500,000 to provide funds for the City's Climate Change Program to improve protection against flooding and extreme heat.

CMA 2026-103

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

10. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$7,500,000 to provide funds for the sewer Combined Sewer Overflow Control Program.

CMA 2026-104

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

11. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$1,000,000 to provide funds for design and construction of the Harvard Square sewer separation and stormwater management program.

CMA 2026-105

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

12. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$310,000 to provide funds for the replacement of Ozone generators at the Water Department.

CMA 2026-106

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

13. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation and authorization to borrow \$2,000,000 to provide funds for water works construction projects for repairs and replacement of water distribution infrastructure.

CMA 2026-107

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading and Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

14. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-20 regarding a report on major capital initiatives at or above \$15,000,000 for the period from FY21 to FY26.

CMA 2026-91

RESULT: Referred to the Finance Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

15. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a response to Awaiting Report Item Number 26-23 regarding the Cambridge Preschool Program.

CMA 2026-92

RESULT: Referred to the Human Services & Veterans Committee [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

16. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the re-appointments for the Cambridge Library Board of Trustees.

CMA 2026-94

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

17. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Family Policy Council appointment and reappointment.

CMA 2026-97

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

18. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appointment of Fiqir Worku to the Human Rights Commission.

CMA 2026-114

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None
PRESENT: None
ABSENT: None

19. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to Peace Commission Appointments.

CMA 2026-117

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None
PRESENT: None
ABSENT: None

20. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation of the FY26 Mass Cultural Council Cultural Investment Portfolio grant made by the Massachusetts Cultural Council (MCC) in the amount of \$1,100 to the Grant Fund Arts Council salaries and wages account.

CMA 2026-108

RESULT: Order Adopted and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None
PRESENT: None
ABSENT: None

21. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation of \$5,000 to the Grant Fund Arts Council Other Ordinary Maintenance account.

CMA 2026-109

RESULT: Order Adopted and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None
PRESENT: None
ABSENT: None

22. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation of the Shannon Grant received from the Metropolitan Mayors Coalition/Shannon Community Safety Initiative through the Executive Office of Public Safety in the amount of \$29,376.89 to the Grant

Fund Human Service Programs Salary and Wages account (\$28,800.00) and to the Grant Fund Human Service Programs Other Ordinary Maintenance account (\$576.89).

CMA 2026-110

RESULT: Order Adopted and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

23. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Mass Ave Active Use zoning petition.

CMA 2026-112

RESULT: Adopted as a City Council Zoning Petition and Referred to the Ordinance Committee and Planning Board for Hearing and Report [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

Massachusetts Avenue Active Use Zoning petition

ORD 2026-05

RESULT: Referred to the Ordinance Committee and Planning Board for Hearing and Report [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

24. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Cambridge Street Active Use zoning petition.

CMA 2026-113

RESULT: Adopted as a City Council Zoning Petition and Referred to the Ordinance Committee and Planning Board for Hearing and Report [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

Cambridge Street Active Use Zoning petition
ORD 2026-06

RESULT: Referred to the Ordinance Committee and Planning Board for Hearing and Report [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

25. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a Surveillance Technology Impact Report (STIR) for SMS Non-Emergency Alert Notifications requested by the Communications & Community Engagement Department.

CMA 2026-111

RESULT: Approved and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

V. POLICY ORDERS

1. That the City Manager is requested to report back to the City Council within ninety (90) with a brief written update describing: (a) the updates made to succession-planning and employee-ownership materials; (b) the status of the worker-cooperative technical-assistance referral pipeline; (c) any guidance issued or planned regarding below-threshold quote-seeking from worker-owned cooperatives and related vendor-outreach steps; and (d) any additional low-cost, staff-feasible next steps the City Manager recommends for expanding support for worker-owned cooperatives in Cambridge.

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR NOLAN

POR 2026-78

RESULT: Adopted [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Councillor Simmons

2. That the City Council go on record endorsing the May Day Strong national day of action on May 1, 2026, as an expression of Cambridge's support for workers' rights, economic justice, and the tradition of peaceful civic engagement.

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN

POR 2026-79

RESULT: Adopted [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Councillor Simmons

3. That the City Council encourage MassDOT to implement infrastructure improvements to the Museum Way and Charles River Dam Road intersection.

COUNCILLOR ZUSY
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
VICE MAYOR AZEEM

POR 2026-80

RESULT: Adopted [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

4. That the City Manager is requested to direct appropriate departments to develop an accessible "Neighbors' Guide to the MFH Ordinance."

**COUNCILLOR ZUSY
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY**

POR 2026-81

RESULT: Adopted [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

5. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant staff to explore options for commissioning a housing needs study through a qualified research institution, to establish a clear evidence-based understanding of existing housing conditions, resident needs, and measurable housing goals to guide future decision-making.

**CHARTER RIGHT EXERCISED BY COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
IN COUNCIL APRIL 27, 2026**

**COUNCILLOR ZUSY
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY**

POR 2026-82

RESULT: Charter Right Exercised by Councillor Simmons

VI. CALENDAR

CHARTER RIGHT

1. That the City Manager is requested to direct the Cambridge Department of Transportation (CDOT) and any other relevant departments to halt any further design, engineering, procurement, or construction activities related to implementing a reconfiguration of Garden Street to restore two-way motor-vehicle traffic.

POR 2026-76

RESULT: Adopted [5-4-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy,

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

2. Chapter 2.129 Welcoming Community Ordinance

ORD 2026-03

RESULT: Ordained [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

VII. COMMUNICATIONS

1. Communications for April 27, 2026 Regular City Council Meeting.

COM 2026-18

RESULT: Placed on File [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem

VIII. RESOLUTIONS

1. Resolution on the retirement of Mary Greene from the City of Cambridge.

MAYOR SIDDQUI

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI

VICE MAYOR AZEEM

COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY

COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN

COUNCILLOR NOLAN

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER

COUNCILLOR ZUSY

RES 2026-65

RESULT: Adopted [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem

2. Resolution for National Library Week

MAYOR SIDDIQUI

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI

VICE MAYOR AZEEM

COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY

COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN

COUNCILLOR NOLAN

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER

COUNCILLOR ZUSY

RES 2026-67

RESULT: Adopted [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem

IX. COMMITTEE REPORTS

1. The Government Operations, Rules, and Claims Committee held a public hearing on Tuesday, March 24, 2026 to discuss the 2026 City Manager's Annual Goals and Review Process.

CC 2026-45

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem

2. The Ordinance Committee held a public hearing on Monday, March 30, 2026 to review the Community Benefits Ordinance and discuss potential updates including allowing the allocation of funding to community organizations for capital projects. The Ordinance Committee voted favorably to forward the proposed amendments to the Community Benefits Ordinance to the full City Council with a favorable recommendation.

CC 2026-46

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File [7-0-2]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern

- A. Chapter 2.127 Community Benefits Advisory Committee Ordinance.

ORD 2026-04

RESULT: Passed to a Second Reading as Amended [7-0-2]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern

X. COMMUNICATIONS FROM OTHER CITY OFFICERS

1. A communication was received from Interim City Clerk Paula Crane, regarding an update regarding legislative activity.

COF 2026-62

RESULT: Placed on File [8-0-1]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Councillor McGovern

XI. APPENDED INFORMATION

1. Awaiting Report Status Update 4.27.26

AWAITING REPORT LIST

1. That the City Manager is requested to work with the School Department, the Department of Public Works, and other relevant departments to ensure that all city owned parking lots, with a focus on school complexes, including the still under construction parking at Tobin/Darby Vassal school complex, could be made available for after-hours use by residents. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-29
Councillor Nolan

AR 2026-02

2. The City Manager is requested to work with all relevant departments to seek input from the community as well as direct outreach to condo owners and short-term rental operators and develop additional recommendations based on the discussion in the Ordinance Committee. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-51
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-04
3. Review the previous home rule petition and prepare a new petition that would allow Cambridge to enact a Real Estate Transfer Fee to be sent to the state legislature. Original Awaiting Report AR-25-69
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-06
4. Restricting Eligibility for On-Street Resident Parking Permits in New Transit-Oriented Developments. Original Awaiting Report 31839
Councillor Zusy, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-07
5. That the City Manager conduct a comprehensive review of existing safety and security measures at Cambridge City Hall, including an assessment of physical access controls, visitor screening practices, on-site security staffing and training, emergency response and evacuation protocols, and the use of security technologies such as surveillance systems and alarm monitoring.
Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-14
6. The City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department (CDD) to examine the feasibility, legal considerations, and administrative requirements of permitting qualified third-party guarantors or co-signers for applicants to Inclusionary Housing units and provide recommendations as to whether such a policy could responsibly expand access to these units.
Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-16
7. The City Manager is requested to direct the appropriate departments to review the city's digital equity work to date, including the study's recommendations and all steps taken since the study conclusion in order to update the evaluation of existing internet access programs, assessing whether residents' digital needs are or could be better provided for and to propose how we can better meet their needs and to report back to the Council by June 2026 on internet access programs.
Councillor Zusy, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Vice Mayor Azeem
AR 2026-18
8. That the City Manager is requested to assess opportunities to improve the consistency of how meeting information is posted and accessed on the City's website.
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler
AR 2026-19
9. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to produce and deliver to the City Council, prior to the adoption of the FY27 Capital Budget, a consolidated capital lifecycle reconciliation for all major capital initiatives.

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File

10. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments as well as the Election Commissioners to review guidance from the IRS and consult with other municipalities in order to simplify our processes for paying election workers.

Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Zusy
AR 2026-22

11. That the City Manager is requested to work with the City Council and relevant City departments on the process by which Cambridge can expand free early child care offerings, including models for means-tested programming, and exploration of non-City funding sources, from the state or foundations.

Councillor Nolan, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-23

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File

12. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to instruct all City departments, boards, commissions, and offices to discontinue all official posting and engagement on X within 60 days; and to include an explanation of why the City will no longer use X.

Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-25

13. That the City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department and the Transportation Department to meet with Harvard's Office of Community Relations and the Longwood Collective (MASCO) to harmonize institutional bus protocols with public-facing commitments.

Councillor Al-Zubi, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-26

14. That the City Manager is requested to direct relevant City departments and staff to examine and report back on whether the city can require single-stall public bathrooms to be gender-neutral.

Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Al-Zubi, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Nolan, Vice Mayor Azeem

AR 2026-27

15. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant departments to review the current legal landscape and provide recommendations for how to regulate construction of large data centers in Cambridge.

Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Zusy

AR 2026-28

16. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to raise the fee of the parking permit program for all residents to \$75, consider how to include a self-identified check off option so as not to increase administrative costs for a subsidized fee of \$25 for residents who live in affordable housing, are enrolled in a program such as SNAP or are low income, remove

the senior exemption for the residential parking permit program and lower the number of cars that individual residents are allowed to get a residential parking permit for from four to two. Councillor Nolan, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-29

17. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested work with relevant City departments to provide a report on how the decision to install artificial turf was made, the rationale for artificial turf, and what process was taken to ensure community concerns and public health considerations were fully addressed, and to ensure that construction will not move forward until a report is delivered.
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-30

XII. ADJOURNMENT

HEARING SCHEDULE

Hearing Schedule